

MIKE E. UNDERWOOD

Principal Solutions Architect

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SUMMARY

Principal Solutions Architect and technology leader with 35+ years of experience designing, modernizing, and delivering software and technology solutions across complex enterprise environments. Deep experience in enterprise architecture, technology strategy, application modernization, cloud adoption, API and integration architecture, and distributed systems.

18 years at Fiserv supporting high-volume payment, billing, and money-movement platforms used by thousands of financial institutions, followed by architecture leadership at AXIS Capital and Rightpoint across financial services, insurance, healthcare, retail, entertainment, and digital commerce.

Combines strategic architecture leadership with deep technical experience, translating business objectives into practical technology strategies and scalable solutions while guiding teams from architecture and design through implementation and delivery.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Architecture & Strategy:** Enterprise Architecture, Solutions Architecture, Technology Strategy, Application Modernization, Cloud Architecture, Digital Transformation, Distributed Systems, Architecture Roadmaps
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** Microsoft Azure, Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Azure VMs, AWS Lambda, Cloud-Native Architecture, CI/CD, Observability
- **Integration & APIs:** REST APIs, .NET Web APIs, API Architecture, Integration Architecture, Azure Service Bus, Event-Driven Architecture, Microservices, SOA
- **Application & Data:** .NET, C#, ASP.NET, Java, JavaScript, SQL Server, Oracle, Informix, Mainframe/iSeries Integration
- **Engineering Practices:** Legacy Modernization, Strangler Fig Pattern, Reference Architectures, Integration Patterns, Technical Standards, Performance Optimization, Distributed Tracing, DevOps

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Technology Consultant & Advisor

Self-employed | Leesburg, GA | Dec 2025 – Apr 2026

Focused on independent technology consulting, architecture advisory, and continued professional development in enterprise architecture, cloud modernization, digital transformation, and emerging technology.

- Evaluated enterprise architecture, cloud, application modernization, and integration strategies to assess technology approaches, architectural options, and modernization opportunities.
- Applied extensive experience in software architecture, engineering, cloud platforms, and distributed systems to evaluate technical solutions and enterprise technology strategies.
- Expanded expertise in emerging technologies, including AI-enabled operations, cloud-native architecture, and digital transformation, with a focus on their practical application in enterprise environments.

Rightpoint Consulting

Solutions Architect | Digital Operations Architecture

Remote | Jan 2020 – Nov 2025

Provided technology architecture and technical leadership for enterprise clients across healthcare, financial services, entertainment, retail, and ecommerce, focusing on digital transformation, application modernization, cloud adoption, and integration architecture.

Key Contributions

- Partnered with business and technology stakeholders to evaluate solution options, establish technical direction, and align near-term delivery with longer-term technology strategy.
- Architected payment and integration workflows using .NET Web APIs, Azure Service Bus, and AWS Lambda to support reliable, event-driven processing.
- Designed cloud deployment architectures across Azure Kubernetes Service (AKS), Azure VMs, and serverless platforms, including CI/CD and observability capabilities.
- Defined API specifications, integration contracts, reference architectures, and reusable technical patterns to promote consistent implementation across engineering teams.
- Diagnosed complex issues across APIs, data layers, and cloud infrastructure using logging, metrics, distributed tracing, and telemetry to improve reliability and performance.
- Provided technical leadership and mentoring to engineering and QA teams on architecture, implementation patterns, debugging, technical quality, and delivery practices.

AXIS Capital

Application Delivery Lead | Enterprise Architecture

Alpharetta, GA | Mar 2018 – Dec 2019

Provided architectural leadership for enterprise initiatives, aligning application and integration architectures with CIO-level objectives and enterprise architecture principles.

Key Contributions

- Translated business requirements into application and integration architectures aligned with enterprise standards and technology strategy.
- Led application modernization initiatives across distributed teams, providing technical direction from requirements and architecture through implementation and deployment.
- Established architectural and development practices that improved consistency, maintainability, reliability, and delivery quality across enterprise applications.
- Built automation tooling to streamline deployment, testing, and engineering workflows.
- Served as technical lead and Scrum Master, coordinating distributed teams and facilitating communication between technical and business stakeholders.
- Applied deep technical expertise to resolve complex application, integration, database, and infrastructure challenges.

Fiserv

18-year progression through technology architecture and engineering leadership roles

Alpharetta, GA | Dec 1999 – Feb 2018

Led architecture, modernization, and technology initiatives for high-volume payment, billing, and money-movement platforms serving thousands of financial institutions.

Principal Solutions Architect | Aug 2014 – Feb 2018

- Defined a three-year business and technology roadmap for the CheckFreePay division, aligning technology direction with business strategy.
- Led modernization of the Walk-In Payments platform, migrating legacy Informix and Unix systems to modern .NET and SQL Server architectures and improving performance by 30%.
- Applied the Strangler Fig approach to incrementally decompose legacy workflows into domain-aligned services.
- Designed barcode-based POS payment workflows and supporting .NET Web Service APIs.
- Established PCI-aligned architecture and audit-ready operational controls for payment platforms.

Manager & Lead Senior Software Architect | Mar 2012 – Jul 2014

- Led multi-team modernization initiatives and delivery of a unified .NET Web Service API layer across .NET and Java products.
- Managed the Biller Solutions architecture team, including hiring, coaching, and performance evaluation.
- Established architecture roadmaps, integration patterns, and technical standards aligned with business strategy.
- Mentored senior engineers and strengthened architectural capabilities across the organization.

Senior Software Architect | Sep 2008 – Feb 2012

- Delivered the eBill Easy Activation platform, increasing activations by 230%.
- Designed cross-platform authentication architecture that reduced digital certificates from hundreds to one.
- Architected SaaS APIs supporting more than 4,000 financial sponsors, including Bank of America.
- Designed distributed services and integration patterns across .NET, Java, and Oracle environments.

Software Architect | Jul 2001 – Aug 2008

- Designed Java and ASP.NET payment solutions, several of which were commercialized or sold to third parties.
- Designed Java biller-direct payment platforms integrating iSeries and mainframe systems.
- Co-designed .NET-based SOA capabilities exposing mainframe payment and billing functionality.
- Provided technical design and implementation guidance across distributed and legacy systems.

Senior Software Engineer | Dec 1999 – Jun 2001

- Developed core payment and billing platform components supporting high-volume financial workflows.
- Contributed to distributed system design, integration patterns, performance optimization, and secure application development.

RIB Software

Senior Software Engineer | Atlanta, GA | Jul 1991 – Nov 1999

Developed commercial construction software and enterprise applications, progressing into increasingly complex application and integration work.

- Developed C++ software components for commercial construction applications backed by Oracle databases.
- Designed and delivered custom integrations and application enhancements for enterprise clients.
- Improved application performance, reliability, and functionality through software design and implementation.
- Contributed to modernization of legacy application components as business and technology requirements evolved.

Sales Technologies

Software Engineer | Buckhead, GA | Jul 1990 – Jul 1991

Developed enterprise sales-force automation software using C++ and Oracle, supporting production applications and evolving business requirements.

- Developed modular C++ components for enterprise sales-force automation applications.
- Designed database-integrated functionality using Oracle, with emphasis on performance, scalability, and reliability.
- Supported production delivery and enhancements across the software development lifecycle.

Universal Microsystems, Inc.

Software Engineer | Peachtree Corners, GA | Jul 1987 – Jun 1990

Developed custom business applications for accounting, inventory, and operational functions using Clipper and dBase III.

- Designed data models, application workflows, and modular software components to support business requirements.
- Supported the software development lifecycle from requirements and design through implementation and deployment.

EDUCATION

Master of Science, Computer Information Systems – Georgia State University

Bachelor of Business Administration, Computer Information Systems – Georgia State University

CERTIFICATIONS

- Sitecore Experience Solution 9 Developer – Aug 2020